Finance operations handbook. This handbook describes how the finance department handles the documents and records it receives each day.

3.1 Archive Topic 1

Invoices received from suppliers are archived by the accounts payable team once payment is made, and the archive of invoices is searchable by number.

3.2 Archive Topic 2

A retention schedule for invoices and data records is maintained by the finance department, and the schedule lists each class of archived data.

3.3 Archive Topic 3

When an archived invoice is requested by an auditor, the data retention officer retrieves it from the archive and logs the request.

3.4 Archive Topic 4

Invoice data is retained in the ledger system and the archive of paid invoices is reviewed each year under the data retention rules.

3.5 Archive Topic 5

Customer invoices are archived in the same way as supplier invoices, and the data retention rules for archived invoices apply equally to both.

3.6 Archive Topic 6

The retention of invoice data after a supplier relationship ends is governed by the archive policy and reviewed by the compliance team.

3.7 Archive Topic 7

Archived invoices are stored in the document archive with their data retention class recorded so that retention reviews can find them.

3.8 Archive Topic 8

Credit notes are archived with the invoices they cancel, and the data retention period for an archived invoice also covers its credit notes.

Notes. The cafeteria on the ground floor opens at eight, the car park gate is locked at seven in the evening, and visitors must sign in at the front desk before they are given a pass and escorted to a room by the person they have come to see. Lost passes are reported to the front desk, which issues a temporary one for the day.

4.2 Data Retention Policy for Archived Invoices

The finance team handles the paperwork for this section with great care every month. Material of this kind is kept for seven years and then securely destroyed by the finance team, following sign-off from the controller and a final check of the file.

The cafeteria on the ground floor opens at eight and the car park gate is locked at seven in the evening on every working day.

3.9 Archive Topic 9

The archive of invoices is backed up nightly, and the backup of archived invoice data follows the same retention policy as the live archive.

3.10 Archive Topic 10

Retention of invoice images scanned from paper follows the data retention policy for archived invoices, and scans are indexed in the archive.

3.11 Archive Topic 11

Access to archived invoices is restricted by role, and each access to archived invoice data is recorded as part of the retention audit trail.

3.12 Archive Topic 12

Disposal of data from the invoice archive is approved by the retention officer, and a disposal log of archived invoices is kept for review.

3.13 Archive Topic 13

Invoices that are under dispute are placed on hold in the archive and are exempt from routine data retention disposal until resolved.

3.14 Archive Topic 14

Training on invoice archive handling and the data retention policy is given to every new member of the accounts payable team on joining.

3.15 Archive Topic 15

Reports on archived invoice volumes and data retention compliance are produced quarterly by finance and shared with the audit committee.

3.16 Archive Topic 16

Exceptions to the invoice archive retention rules must be requested in writing and approved by the head of finance before they take effect.

3.17 Archive Topic 17

The data retention policy for archived invoices is reviewed by the compliance team every year. Each archived invoice carries a retention date, and invoices past that date are listed for the retention officer.

3.18 Archive Topic 18

Archived invoices from overseas suppliers follow the same data retention policy as domestic invoices. The invoice archive records the country of each supplier so that local retention rules can be checked on request.

3.19 Archive Topic 19

Retention periods for invoice data are set out in the retention schedule. The schedule says how long archived invoices and the data attached to them must be kept before the archive may release them.

3.20 Archive Topic 20

A data retention policy review of the invoice archive found that archived invoices were indexed consistently. The review of archived invoice retention was presented to the audit committee in full.

3.21 Archive Topic 21

The archive stores each invoice with its approval data, payment data and retention class. Archived invoice data can be exported for an auditor, and the export is subject to the data retention policy.

3.22 Archive Topic 22

Duplicate invoices found in the archive are merged under the data retention policy. The archived invoice that is kept is the earliest one, and the retention officer records the merge in the invoice archive log.

3.23 Archive Topic 23

Staff who need an archived invoice submit a request to the archive. The request names the invoice number, and the data retention officer checks that the retention policy allows the invoice to be released.

3.24 Archive Topic 24

Legal holds override the data retention policy for archived invoices. While a hold is in force the invoice archive keeps every affected invoice, and the retention officer lifts the hold when legal agrees.

3.25 Archive Topic 25

Invoice archive storage costs are reported with the data retention figures. Longer retention of archived invoices raises the cost of the archive, and finance weighs that cost against the retention policy.

3.26 Archive Topic 26

The data retention policy applies to electronic invoices received by email as well as to paper invoices. Archived invoice emails are kept in the archive with the same retention class as the invoice itself.

3.27 Archive Topic 27

Archive migration projects must preserve invoice data and retention dates. After a migration the retention officer samples archived invoices to confirm that the data retention policy is still being applied.

3.28 Archive Topic 28

Quarterly checks confirm that archived invoices older than the retention period have been disposed of. The invoice archive report lists any data retention exceptions for the audit committee to review.